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TECHNICAL AND COMMERCIAL PROPOSAL

ZimSwim Online

A public website and secure management backend for swimming in Zimbabwe: membership by age group, online training for parent officials, gala scheduling and results, and a national venue register.

7 days	6	11	USD 1,250
Build to go-live	Integrated modules	Access levels	Year 1, build and hosting

PREPARED FOR
Zimbabwe Swimming
Board and Secretariat

PREPARED BY
Leading Digital
Kudzai Jeche, Founder and CEO
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CONTACT
support@leadingdigital.africa
+263 774 685 884
leadingdigital.africa

01 Executive summary

> Leading Digital proposes ZimSwim Online: one web platform that runs the swimming year end to end. Parents register swimmers by age group, train online to become technical officials, enter galas, pay, and see results, while ZimSwim schedules galas, allocates pools and officials, and publishes rankings and records from the same data.

It is two things working together: a **public website** anyone can visit, and a **secure management backend** where the ZimSwim board, provincial administrators, clubs, officials and parents each log in with their own access level.

We will build and launch it in a **7-day sprint**: a dedicated team works on the modules in parallel on Leading Digital's production Laravel and React stack, and ZimSwim supplies content and approvals on fixed days. Day 7 is go-live, in time for this season's provincial galas and well ahead of the February 2027 senior nationals. A four-week hardening phase follows while the platform runs its first live galas.

What ZimSwim gets

Public website

News, season calendar, rules, records, rankings, clubs and sponsors.

Membership

Swimmers, clubs, coaches and officials, with age groups calculated automatically.

Officials Academy

Online courses, exams, poolside sign-off and certificates for parent officials.

Gala management

Scheduling, online entries, heat sheets, live results, records and rankings.

Venue register

Pools graded by lanes, length and timing equipment; availability and booking.

Payments

EcoCash, OneMoney, Visa and Mastercard through Paynow, with automatic receipts.

Investment: USD 1,250 for year 1, covering the platform build (USD 1,100, including four weeks of post-launch hardening and support) and first-year hosting (USD 150), with server hosting complimentary in the first year. From year 2, hosting renews at USD 150 a year. An optional parent and officials mobile app can follow from USD 2,500.

02 What we learned: swimming in Zimbabwe

> Zimbabwe swimming runs on volunteers, a handful of competition pools and a long summer season, and the platform has to fit that reality rather than an imported model.

Who runs what. Zimbabwe Swimming administers the sport nationally and runs the national calendar, including the National Sprint Gala and senior nationals. National records are ratified by the Zimbabwe Aquatic Union, the World Aquatics member federation. Provincial bodies such as Harare Amateur Swimming and the Matabeleland swimming board run local galas and championships.

Scale. The National Sprint Gala has run for 40 years and drew more than 1,200 swimmers from 16 clubs in Mutare. Harare's senior provincial championships draw around 200 swimmers over two weekends, and a Harare season opener had 98 swimmers from seven clubs. Paper entries and manual heat sheets do not scale to these numbers.

Age groups vary by gala. Reported events use bands such as 9 and under, 10 years, 11 to 12, 12 and under, 13 to 14, 15 and under and 17 and over. Records run on the calendar year to December. The system must let each gala define its own bands and age-up date.

The season. The City of Harare reopened its 13 public pools on 21 August 2026; they run nine months a year with a winter maintenance break. Galas therefore cluster between September and April, with senior nationals in February.

Venues are the bottleneck. Zimbabwe Swimming says only three pools, in Harare, Bulawayo and Mutare, are functional and up to standard for national events, and the Mutare pool has no electronic timing. Les Brown Pool hosts most Harare events; Harare Amateur Swimming is refurbishing the 50 m by 25 m, 10-lane Mufakose pool with the City of Harare as an alternative. Bulawayo City Pool has had maintenance problems, and clubs rely on school pools for training. ZimSwim's stated goal is a club in every district, which means more venues to track.

Results travel regionally. Zimbabwe competes in Africa Aquatics Zone IV (CANA Zone IV) and the AUSC Region 5 Youth Games, and has entered virtual age-group championships where national results were combined into regional rankings. Results must export in standard formats.

Officials are mostly parents. World Aquatics' Swimming Development Level 1 course for technical officials covers the strokes, disqualifications and protocols over two classroom days, then a day of pool practice and an exam. Federations such as Swim England and Swimming Australia now deliver the theory online and keep the practical poolside, and most of their officials are swimmers' parents. That blended model fits ZimSwim's parent training directly.

Children's data is regulated. The Cyber and Data Protection Act, 2021 is enforced by POTRAZ; processing data of anyone under 18 needs a parent or guardian's consent, and data controllers must run impact assessments for children's data. Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 adds licensing of data controllers and appointment of a data protection officer.

Governance needs clarity. There have been press reports of parallel structures between Zimbabwe Swimming and Zimbabwe Aquatics, including rival national galas. The platform records clearly which body sanctions each gala and ratifies each record.

03 The problems the platform solves

> Each problem below maps to a module in the platform.

Today	With ZimSwim Online
Swimmer details re-captured on paper for every gala; ages and age groups checked by hand	One verified profile per swimmer; age group calculated from date of birth and each gala's age-up date
Too few qualified officials, trained in occasional face-to-face sessions that parents in Gweru or Masvingo cannot reach	Online theory any time, on a phone, with poolside practicals booked and signed off at the nearest gala
No central register of who is qualified, at what level, or whose licence has lapsed	Officials register with levels, sessions worked, expiry dates and QR-verifiable certificates
Entries collected by club secretaries in spreadsheets and WhatsApp, fees chased manually	Online entries with deadlines, qualifying-time checks and payment at the point of entry
Heat sheets and results typed up and shared as photos and PDFs	Heat sheets generated from entries; results published live and stored permanently
Records and rankings maintained by individuals	Records proposed automatically when broken, ratified in the system, rankings per age group and course
Venue choice limited to what organisers remember about each pool	Venue register with pool length, lanes, depth, timing equipment, seating, condition and availability
Clashing galas and no single season calendar	One national calendar with provincial and club galas, clash warnings and sanction status
Children's personal data held informally	Parent consent captured, access by role, audit trail, aligned to the Cyber and Data Protection Act

04 Platform overview: the modules

> ZimSwim Online is one system, not six: every module reads and writes the same swimmer, official, gala and venue records, so a time entered at a gala updates the results page, the swimmer's best times, the rankings and the record list at once.

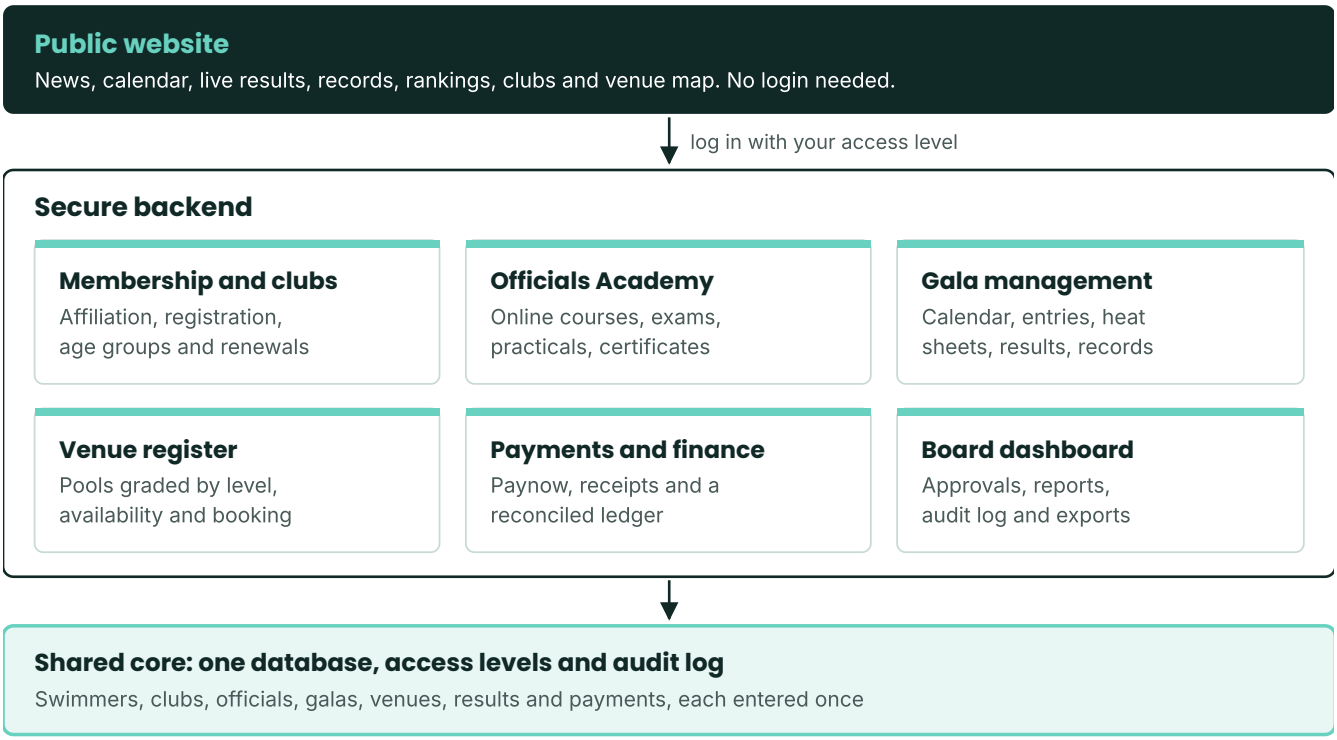


Figure 1. The public website shows what the backend publishes; each user's access level decides which modules and records they can open.

05 Officials Academy: online training for parents

> The Academy turns a parent with no background into a licensed official through online theory, a short exam and signed-off poolside practice, so the classroom day is no longer the bottleneck.

The pathway

We propose levels modelled on the World Aquatics structure used by most federations; ZimSwim confirms the final names, minimum ages and hours.

Level	Roles covered	Online theory	Practical before certification
Timekeeper	Timekeeper	Rules overview, stopwatch and backup timing, recording times; short quiz	2 gala sessions with a chief timekeeper
Judge Level 1	Chief timekeeper, inspector of turns	Starts, turns and finishes for each stroke; relay takeovers; quiz	4 gala sessions, signed off by a referee

Level	Roles covered	Online theory	Practical before certification
Judge Level 2	Judge of stroke, finish judge	Stroke rules in full, disqualification codes, video case studies; exam	Mentored sessions plus a practical assessment
Starter	Starter	Start protocol, false starts, signals; exam	Supervised starts at galas
Referee	Referee, meet management	Protests, protocol, running officials; exam	Assessed by a senior referee

What a parent experiences

1. Registers once, linked to their child's club, and picks a course.
2. Works through short video lessons in English, with Shona and Ndebele summaries as a later option. Lessons stream at low bandwidth and can be downloaded for offline viewing.
3. Takes quizzes after each lesson and a timed final exam drawn at random from a question bank, so no two exams are identical.
4. Books practical sessions at upcoming galas from the calendar; the gala's referee confirms attendance and signs each session off on a phone.
5. Receives a digital certificate with a QR code that anyone can scan to confirm the level and expiry date.
6. Gets reminders before the licence expires, with a short refresher course and a rule-change update whenever World Aquatics rules change.

What ZimSwim controls. Course builder for lessons, videos, PDFs and questions; pass marks and retake limits; cohorts for live webinars where a Zoom or Google Meet link is attached to a lesson; trainer and assessor roles; reports on how many officials each club and province has at each level.

Fees. Courses can be free, paid, or free for parents of registered swimmers. Payment and certificate issue are automatic.

> **Why it matters for galas:** the gala module reads the officials register, so when ZimSwim plans a gala it can see who is qualified and nearby, invite them, and confirm a full panel before entries close.

06 Gala and competition management

> The gala module takes a gala from an idea on the calendar to ratified results, with ZimSwim approving each step and clubs and parents doing their own data entry.

Scheduling and sanction. Provinces and clubs submit a gala request: name, level (club, provincial, national, invitational), proposed dates, venue, course (25 m or 50 m), age groups, events and fees. The system warns of clashes with other galas and with the venue's bookings. The board or technical committee approves it, and the gala appears on the public calendar with a sanction badge.

Event programme. Organisers build the programme from templates (sprint gala, age-group championships, senior nationals) or from scratch: events, sessions, age bands, age-up date, qualifying and cut-off times, relay rules and entry limits per swimmer.

Online entries. Club administrators and parents enter swimmers from their registered profiles. The system blocks wrong age groups and checks qualifying times against the swimmer's best results. Entries close automatically at the deadline; late entries need organiser approval. Fees are paid by Paynow at the point of entry, per swimmer or as one club invoice.

Seeding and heat sheets. After entries close, the system seeds heats by entry time, assigns lanes using standard centre-lane seeding, and produces heat sheets and a printable programme. Organisers can also export entries in Lenex or Hy-Tek format to run the meet in existing meet software such as Hy-Tek Meet Manager or SPLASH.

On the day. Officials panel and duty roster from the officials register; call room check-in by phone; times captured on a tablet by the recorder or imported from timing software; disqualifications recorded with the rule code.

Results, records, rankings. Results publish live to the website as each event is confirmed. Personal bests update automatically. When a time beats a provincial or national record, the system flags it for ratification, and the record changes only after the authorised body approves it. Rankings are kept per age group, gender, stroke, distance and course, and export for regional rankings such as Africa Aquatics Zone IV.

After the gala. Medal and points tables, club trophies, a results PDF, and a gala report for the board covering entries, revenue, officials used and any protests.

07 End-to-end process: the life of a gala

> Every gala follows the same eight steps in the system, and each step has one owner, so nobody has to chase paper or WhatsApp groups to know where a gala stands.

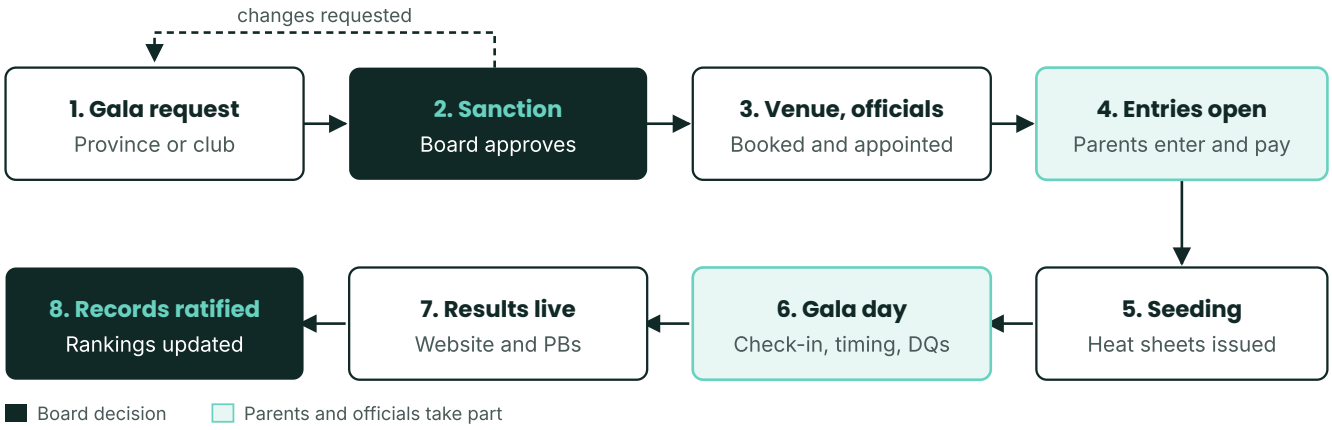


Figure 2. The board approves twice: before entries open, and before a record stands. Results go live immediately; records wait for ratification.

08 Venues: identifying and booking pools

> The venue register gives ZimSwim one verified list of every pool that can host a gala, graded by the level of gala it can carry, so venue decisions are made from facts rather than memory.

What each venue record holds. Owner (city council, school, club, private), contact person, address and map pin, pool length (25 m or 50 m), number of lanes, depth at each end, starting blocks, backstroke flags and ledges, electronic timing and scoreboard, warm-up pool, seating capacity, changing rooms, parking, power backup, water quality and the date of the last inspection, photos, and seasonal opening dates.

Venue grading

Each pool gets a grade that the gala module checks before a gala is approved.

Grade	Can host	Minimum requirements (to be set by ZimSwim)
National	Senior nationals, sprint gala, international meets	50 m or approved 25 m pool, 8 or more lanes, blocks, electronic timing preferred, seating and warm-up area
Provincial	Provincial championships and age-group galas	25 m or 50 m, 6 or more lanes, blocks, manual timing panel
Club and development	Club galas, development and learn-to-swim events	Safe depth, lane ropes, lifeguard cover

Starting list from our research

Venue	City	What we know
Les Brown Pool	Harare	Hosts most Harare national and provincial events; official launch venue for the City's 2026 summer season
Mufakose Pool	Harare	50 m by 25 m, 10 lanes, deeper than Les Brown; being refurbished by Harare Amateur Swimming with the City of Harare
Other City of Harare pools	Harare	13 public pools in total, open nine months a year
Bulawayo City Pool	Bulawayo	Hosts senior nationals and regional championships; has had maintenance problems
Hillside Teachers College	Bulawayo	Used for junior galas
Mutare City Pool ("Main Bath")	Mutare	Home of the National Sprint Gala, hosted 35 times; no electronic timing
School and club pools	Countrywide	Used by clubs for training and smaller galas; confirmed with provincial bodies during the build

Booking and availability. Venue owners or ZimSwim staff block out dates for maintenance, school use and other events. A gala request shows only available, suitably graded venues, and a confirmed gala books the venue so no second gala can claim it. Hire fees and booking letters are recorded against the gala.

Finding new venues. A map view shows all venues against club locations, so ZimSwim can see districts with clubs but no suitable pool. This supports the plan for a club in every district and conversations with councils, schools and sponsors about upgrades.

09 Backend, access levels, membership and payments

> Everyone logs into the same backend but sees only what their role allows: the board sees the whole country, a province sees its own clubs and galas, a club sees its own swimmers, and a parent sees only their own children.

Access levels

Roles are configurable by ZimSwim's system administrator; this is the proposed starting set.

Role	Who	Can see	Can do
System administrator	ZimSwim secretariat lead, Leading Digital support	Everything	Manage users and roles, settings, age-group rules, audit log
Board member	Chair, vice-chair, secretary, treasurer, conveners	All provinces, clubs, galas, officials, finances, reports	Approve gala sanctions, ratify records, approve affiliations, view financial reports; each convener gets the approvals for their portfolio
Technical committee	Technical and officials conveners, senior referees	Galas, results, officials register, Academy	Approve gala programmes, appoint referees, publish courses, sign off officials levels
Finance	Treasurer and finance officer	Payments, invoices, refunds, revenue by gala and club	Reconcile Paynow payments, issue refunds, export to accounting
Provincial administrator	Harare, Mashonaland, Matabeleland, Manicaland, Midlands and other provincial bodies	Their province's clubs, swimmers, galas, venues	Request galas, run provincial galas, manage venue records in their area
Club administrator	Club secretary or head coach	Their club's swimmers, coaches, entries, invoices	Register and renew swimmers, submit entries, pay club invoices
Coach	Registered coaches	Their squad's profiles and times	View results and PBs, suggest entries
Gala official	Officials appointed to a gala	That gala's heat sheets and duties	Check-in, record times and disqualifications, sign off trainee practicals (referees)
Parent or guardian	Parents of registered swimmers	Their own children only	Register and consent, enter galas, pay, take Academy courses
Swimmer 18 and over	Senior swimmers	Their own profile	Manage own profile and entries
Public	Website visitors	Calendar, results, records, rankings, news	No login needed

> **Controls on sensitive actions:** record ratification and gala sanction need board-level approval and can require two approvers. Every change to a result, record, payment or role is written to an audit log showing who, what and when. Board and finance users get two-factor login.

Board dashboard. A summary for board meetings: registered swimmers by province and age group, affiliated clubs, upcoming galas and their sanction status, officials by level and expiry, revenue by month, and records awaiting ratification. Exportable to PDF and Excel.

Membership and affiliation. Clubs apply to affiliate online and pay an annual fee. Swimmers register through their club or a parent; each gets a unique ZimSwim number used on every entry and result. Annual renewals, transfers between clubs with approval from both clubs, and a public club finder.

Age groups. The system calculates each swimmer's age group from date of birth and each gala's age-up date, using the bands ZimSwim sets, so a swimmer can never be entered in the wrong group.

Payments. Paynow handles EcoCash, OneMoney, Visa and Mastercard for affiliation fees, registration, gala entries and course fees. Every payment issues a receipt, and finance sees a reconciled ledger by gala, club and fee type. Clubs can pay one invoice for all their entries.

Communication. Email and SMS notices for entry deadlines, heat sheets, results and licence renewals, with WhatsApp share links for every gala page.

10 Technology, security and data protection

> The platform runs on the stack Leading Digital uses for its production systems, which is what makes a 7-day build realistic: nothing here is new technology for the team.

Layer	Choice	Why
Backend and admin	Laravel 12, PHP 8.4	Mature roles and permissions, queues, audit logging
Website and portal	React with Inertia.js, mobile-first	One codebase for public site and backend; works on low-end phones
Database	PostgreSQL 16, Redis	Reliable relational data for results and records; fast caching
Live results	Laravel Reverb	Results update on screen without refreshing
Payments	Paynow	EcoCash, OneMoney and cards in Zimbabwe
Video lessons	Streamed with adaptive quality, downloadable	Works on mobile data and weak connections
Data exchange	Lenex and Hy-Tek import and export, Excel, PDF	Works with existing meet software and regional rankings
Hosting	Cloud server with daily off-site backups and SSL	99.5% target uptime, restore within 24 hours

Security. Role-based access on every page and record, two-factor login for board and finance users, encrypted passwords and connections, rate limiting, audit log, and quarterly access reviews with the

secretariat.

Data protection. Designed to meet the Cyber and Data Protection Act and SI 155 of 2024: parent or guardian consent captured and recorded at registration for every swimmer under 18; only the data needed is collected; parents can view, correct, download or request deletion of their child's data; minors' contact details and dates of birth are never public. Leading Digital supplies a privacy notice draft and a data protection impact assessment template; ZimSwim, as data controller, completes POTRAZ registration and appoints a data protection officer.

Safeguarding. Public pages show swimmers by name, club and age group only, with no photos of minors unless the parent opts in. Coaches and officials see only what their role needs, and ZimSwim can record safeguarding and police clearance status for anyone working with children.

11 Delivery plan: the 7-day sprint

> The platform goes live on Day 7, counted from the first working day after sign-off and deposit. A team of developers builds the modules in parallel, and each day has one ZimSwim input that keeps it on track.

Day 1	**Kick-off: scope, roles and age rules confirmed; server and domain set up** ZimSwim: brand assets, board, provincial and club contact lists
Day 2	**Backend: users, access levels, audit log, clubs, swimmer registration** ZimSwim: fees, age bands, officials pathway
Day 3	**Public website, news and calendar; venue register and booking** ZimSwim: website text, pool details
Day 4	**Officials Academy: courses, video lessons, quizzes, exams, certificates** ZimSwim: Timekeeper and Judge Level 1 content, question bank
Day 5	**Galas: sanction flow, programmes, online entries, Paynow payments** ZimSwim: Paynow merchant details
Day 6	**Seeding, heat sheets, live results, records; full mock gala test** ZimSwim: board tests and signs off
Day 7	**Go-live: data loaded, accounts issued, launch; board and admin training** ZimSwim: announce to clubs and parents
Weeks 2 to 5	**Hardening: first live galas supported, fixes, more officials courses** Included in the price; optional retainer starts after week 5

Day 7 delivers every module in this proposal. The officials courses beyond Judge Level 1, fine-tuning of reports and any changes found at the first live galas are completed in the hardening weeks at no extra cost.

12 Investment

Year 1 costs USD 1,250 in total: USD 1,100 for the platform build, delivered in the 7-day sprint with four weeks of hardening and support included, plus USD 150 for first-year hosting. From year 2, hosting renews at USD 150 a year.

Module	Includes	USD
Public website and content management	Home, news, calendar, clubs, records, rankings, rules and documents, sponsors, contact	175
Backend, access levels and membership	Roles and permissions, board dashboard, audit log, club affiliation, swimmer registration, age groups, Paynow payments	275
Officials Academy	Courses, video lessons, quizzes and exams, practical sign-off, QR certificates, officials register	200
Gala management	Calendar, sanction workflow, programmes, online entries, seeding, heat sheets, live results, records, rankings, Lenex and Hy-Tek exchange	325
Venue register and booking	Venue records, grading, availability, booking, map view	125
Platform build		**1,100**
Year 1 hosting	Domain and email hosting; server hosting complimentary in year 1	150
Total year 1		**1,250**

Running costs

Item	Cost	Notes
Hosting: cloud server, backups, SSL, domain and email	USD 150 a year, billed separately from the build	Server hosting is complimentary in year 1; the USD 150 covers domain and email hosting (Business plan) and is paid with the deposit. From year 2, hosting renews at USD 150 a year
Support and maintenance retainer (optional)	USD 250 a month	Updates, security patches, content help, gala-day support
SMS notices	Pay as used	At the SMS provider's rate
Paynow fees	Per transaction	Absorbed by ZimSwim or added to fees

Optional: parent and officials mobile app for Android and iOS (entries, results, push notifications, offline course videos), from USD 2,500, built after the web platform is stable.

Payment schedule

When	Item	USD
On signing	50% deposit	625
On signing	Year 1 hosting (server complimentary; domain and email)	150
On signing	**Amount due to start**	**775**
On go-live, Day 7	Balance	475
Total year 1		**1,250**
Each year from year 2	Hosting renewal	150

Payment terms. Year 1 totals USD 1,250: the platform build (USD 1,100) plus first-year hosting (USD 150). On signing: USD 775 (50% deposit of USD 625 plus first-year hosting of USD 150). On go-live: USD 475 (balance). Hosting is listed separately from the build and renews at USD 150 a year from year 2. Prices are in USD and valid for 30 days from the date of this proposal.

13 Risks, assumptions and next steps

> The 7 days hold if ZimSwim answers questions the same day and has the items below ready by Day 2; the software is the easy part, content and decisions are the risk.

What ZimSwim provides by Day 2

- [ ] One named decision-maker and one technical contact available daily during the sprint
- [ ] Logo, brand guidelines, photos (with consent) and website text, or approval for Leading Digital to draft it
- [ ] Board, provincial and club lists with contact emails for account set-up
- [ ] Age-group bands, age-up date, fee schedule and affiliation rules
- [ ] Officials pathway: levels, minimum ages, practical hours, pass mark
- [ ] Course content for Timekeeper and Judge Level 1: slides, videos or notes, and at least 40 exam questions
- [ ] Known venue details for Harare, Bulawayo and Mutare pools
- [ ] Paynow merchant account, or approval to apply in ZimSwim's name
- [ ] Domain name and any existing website or data to migrate

Risks and how we handle them

Risk	Effect	Mitigation
Course content not ready	Academy launches empty	Launch with Timekeeper and Judge Level 1; Leading Digital drafts lessons from World Aquatics rules for the technical committee to approve; other levels added in hardening
Paynow approval takes longer than 7 days	Online payments not live at launch	Launch with manual payment confirmation by finance; switch Paynow on when approved
Approvals slow during the sprint	Days slip	Daily 15-minute check-in; one decision-maker with authority to sign off
Governance dispute over sanctioning and ratification	Confusion for clubs and parents	Sanctioning and ratifying body set per gala and per record; public pages show which body approved
Low digital confidence among some parents and clubs	Slow adoption	Mobile-first design, club administrators can enter on behalf of parents, short how-to videos, launch support at the first galas
Incomplete historical data	Gaps in records and history	Import what exists, mark unverified data, clubs confirm swimmers at first renewal

Assumptions. English interface at launch; officials theory delivered online with practicals at galas; electronic timing integration limited to importing results files; native seeding covers standard heat-based galas, with Hy-Tek or SPLASH used for complex finals formats if ZimSwim prefers.

Next steps

1. ZimSwim confirms scope and signs this proposal.
2. Deposit and first-year hosting paid (USD 775); the sprint starts the next working day.
3. Kick-off meeting on Day 1 with the board's nominated lead.
4. Go-live on Day 7, followed by board and administrator training and the first live gala in the hardening phase.

For Zimbabwe Swimming
Name, title, signature and date

For Leading Digital
Kudzai Jeche, Founder and CEO

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